



Department of Economics
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November 20, 2025

Search Committee
Department of Economics
Hamilton College
Clinton, NY 13323
USA

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in the tenure-track Assistant Professor position in Economics at Hamilton College. I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University, advised by Professors Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis, and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My research fields are macroeconomics, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda focuses on understanding the determinants of wealth inequality and the mechanisms through which heterogeneity in returns to wealth shapes aggregate outcomes. In my job-market paper, I estimate the degree of heterogeneity in individual portfolio returns using micro-data from the Survey of Consumer Finances and simulate a structural model in which households face idiosyncratic return risk. I show that allowing for persistent heterogeneity in returns substantially improves the model's ability to match the empirical distribution of wealth, offering a tractable way to connect micro-level return dispersion to macroeconomic inequality.

In a second project, I use the Health and Retirement Study to examine the relationship between interpersonal trust and portfolio performance. Building on the literature that finds a hump-shaped relationship between trust and income, I show that a similar relationship holds for individual returns to wealth measured in the HRS data, highlighting a behavioral channel through which social attitudes shape saving and investment outcomes. This work also provides new estimates of the persistent component of returns to net worth, which motivate the calibration of heterogeneity in my structural model.

Hamilton College's Economics Department seeks excellence in undergraduate teaching and scholarship, with particular interest in macroeconomics and related areas such as environmental macroeconomics, the history of economic thought, and technology and innovation. The liberal-arts setting, highlighted by the open curriculum, close faculty-student engagement, and a 9:1 student-faculty ratio, aligns with my student-centered approach. I am also excited by the department's joint seminar series with Colgate University and the expectation of contributing to institutional service, including academic advising after the first year. These features make Hamilton an ideal place to advance my research while mentoring highly motivated undergraduates in a rigorous, inclusive environment.

Teaching. My teaching experience centers on undergraduate macroeconomics and an upper-level macro-policy seminar, where I have led weekly discussion sections and held regular office hours for classes ranging from 16 to 40 students. My approach is student-centered: I aim to help students

“convince themselves” that they have moved from confusion to understanding by holding structured office-hour coaching that builds trust and confidence. At Hamilton, I am prepared to teach *Principles of Macroeconomics*, *Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory*, *Money and Banking*, and *Quantitative Methods for Economics*. I would also welcome developing electives such as *Economics of Inequality and Tax Policy* or *Computational Macroeconomics and Policy*, emphasizing reproducible workflows and evidence-based decision-making.

I would be honored to join Hamilton College’s Department of Economics and contribute to its teaching, research, and service missions. Thank you for your consideration; I welcome the opportunity to discuss my fit with the department at your convenience.

Sincerely,

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